BEATRIZ GIETNER

b.gietner@gmail.com — +353 89 940 1898
beagietner.github.io/webpage — diddigest.xyz

Research Profile

Applied microeconomist working on human capital formation and inequality over the life course. My research studies how skills, family circumstances, and institutions shape educational and labour-market outcomes. My doctoral research combines evidence from Ireland and Japan, using longitudinal cohort data, household panel data, decomposition methods, and event-time designs. I am especially interested in education and labour markets in comparative perspective, with a growing focus on East Asia.

Research Interests

Applied microeconomics; economics of education; labour economics; human capital; educational inequality; gender gaps in achievement; family and labour-market institutions; East Asian education and labour markets; longitudinal data.

Experience

Economist, Science Works *Jul 2026–present*

Writing and Research Communication

Founder and Author, *DiD Digest* *2025–present*

- Newsletter explaining recent work on applied causal inference in clear language for researchers and policy readers.
- 2,285 subscribers across 101 countries and 70K all-time views, with no paid promotion; funded by an Emergent Ventures grant.

Education

PhD in Economics, University College Dublin *2026*
Dissertation: *Three Essays on Human Capital*
Supervisor: Professor Kevin Denny

M.Ed. in Science Education, Trinity College Dublin *2018*

Lic. in Physics, Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina *2013*

BSc in Physics, Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina *2012*

Job Market Paper and Research Papers

On Leave or Out of a Job? The Contract Divide in Employment around Childbirth in Japan
Job market paper.
In Japan, most women stop working around childbirth, whatever their contract. Being out of work, however, can mean two different things: a woman on leave still has a job to return to, while a woman who has lost her job must look for a new one. Using the Keio and Japan Household Panel Surveys, I separate the two and follow women through the years after the birth. Regular and non-regular workers stop working at similar rates, but regular workers are mostly on leave, whereas non-regular workers far more often lose their job. Women who kept a job are more often back at work in later years, and within couples the fall in employment is almost all among mothers.

When Do Gender Gaps in Maths Become Skill Gaps? Evidence from Ireland
Using Growing Up in Ireland, I decompose the gender gap in Leaving Certificate Maths with skills

measured on the same children at ages 9 and 13, pairing tests of the same domain across ages. With age-9 skills, most of the gap is unexplained. With age-13 skills, most of it is explained, above all by numerical ability. In English, girls' advantage remains unexplained by measured skills at both ages. The same examination gap therefore looks different depending on when skills are measured, and in Maths the skills of early adolescence account for most of it.

Cognitive Ability, Attentional Regulation, and Academic Achievement
Using Growing Up in Ireland, I study how cognitive ability and attentional and behavioural regulation at age 13 combine in predicting Junior Certificate results in Maths and English, controlling for skills measured at age 9. The two interact negatively: the return to cognitive ability in examination points is larger for students with weaker regulation. The pattern holds with the class teacher's rating four years earlier and across checks for multiple testing, sample selection and school clustering. With a broad personality measure of conscientiousness, the interaction is close to zero, so the estimate depends on how noncognitive skill is measured.

Teaching Experience

Lecturer, Public Choice, Dublin City University *2026*
Designed and delivered undergraduate teaching in public choice, political economy, and policy analysis.
Teaching Assistant / Tutor, University College Dublin *2020–2024*
Modules included MSc Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics: Microeconometrics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Macroeconomics for Business, Microeconomics for Business, Game Theory, and Industrial Economics.
High School Teacher, Physics and General Science *2014–2016*

Presentations

2026	Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics, Beijing (upcoming); Women in Empirical Microeconomics, Chicago (invited); 8th Japan Economy Network, Tokyo (invited); 11th LEER Conference on Education Economics, Leuven (invited); Lisbon Economics and Statistics of Education (invited); 3rd ISWE Conference, Dublin; 3rd International Doctoral Forum, Beijing; Irish Economic Association.
2025	Public Choice Outreach Conference, Fairfax; ESCoE Conference on Economic Measurement, London; Young Economists' Meeting, Brno (invited); 10th LEER Conference, Leuven; 2nd ISWE Conference, Dublin; 2nd International Doctoral Forum, Beijing; Irish Economic Association.
2024	Progress Conference: Toward Abundant Futures, Berkeley; Causal Inference OCE Conference III, Chicago; Growing Up in Ireland Annual Conference, Dublin; Irish Economic Association.
2022–2023	Irish Economic Association.

Awards and Training

- Emergent Ventures Grant for *DiD Digest* (2025–2026)
- Arnold Ventures Difference-in-Differences Workshop, San Francisco (2024)
- Optimization-Conscious Econometrics Summer School, University of Chicago (2024)
- UCD School of Economics Scholarship (2020–2025); ISWE and AMIE mentoring programmes

Skills and Languages

Technical: R, Stata and Python; Quarto, R Markdown and LaTeX; Git and GitHub; Claude Code and Codex CLI.
Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced), Korean (conversational), Japanese (basic).

References

Professor Kevin Denny
School of Economics
University College Dublin
kevin.denny@ucd.ie

Professor Orla Doyle
School of Economics
University College Dublin
orla.doyle@ucd.ie

Professor Paul Devereux
School of Economics
University College Dublin
devereux@ucd.ie

Professor Joseph Roche
School of Education
Trinity College Dublin
joseph.roche@tcd.ie